

SARAH M. HORTON

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21 years in Software Development, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: GraphQL and FastAPI.

EXPERIENCE

Lumen Works — Senior Full-Stack Developer

Oct '11 – Feb '26

- Built a reusable Django component library adopted by 10 product teams, removing months of duplicated work.
- Set the service-level objectives for 15 services and built the dashboards the team still runs on.
- Drove the team's adoption of trunk-based development, reducing merge conflicts and lead time by 15%.
- Replaced a third-party dependency with an in-house React module, saving \$8k per year in licence fees.
- Introduced contract testing with Java, lifting coverage from 6% to 82% and cutting integration bugs.

Spotify — Backend Developer

Apr '07 – Oct '11

- Owned the customer-facing API end to end on Django, from schema design through on-call support.
- Partnered with product to scope and deliver 3 major releases, each behind staged rollouts.
- Led the migration of a legacy monolith to Java, taking deployments from fortnightly to 6 per day.
- Rewrote the search path in Java, dropping median response from 780ms to 60ms for 20M monthly users.

Full-Stack Developer, Keystone Apps

Feb '04 – Mar '07

- Designed and shipped Django services handling 40k requests per minute, cutting p99 latency from 450ms to 180ms.
- Cut CI build times by 70% by parallelising the Kubernetes pipeline and caching dependency layers.
- Hardened authentication flows in Node.js after a security review, closing 50 findings before audit.

QUALIFICATIONS

Master, Communications

Eastbrook State University | 2002 – 2004

First Class Honours

Thesis: "Framing effects in crisis communication"

Bachelor, Communications

Fairview Institute of Technology | 1998 – 2001

SKILLS

Skill	Experience
GraphQL	18 yrs
FastAPI	10 yrs
Go	16 yrs
Node.js	12 yrs
React	4 yrs
Django	1 year

JavaScript	2 yrs
Java	10 yrs
TypeScript	12 yrs
PostgreSQL	1 year
Git	6 yrs
Kubernetes	6 yrs
Databricks	21 yrs
Snowflake	18 yrs
Confluence	12 yrs
Excel	18 yrs

References available upon request.